Emotions and feelings

The same grey can evoke **calm** in one of us and **emptiness** in another, sometimes even both in one day. There is no single fixed effect. It depends on our body, experience, culture and situation.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

Calm

A feeling that **nothing shouts** and you do not have to show off.

And why?

Grey is a colour without sharp stimuli. After a day when everyone wanted something from you it can be a relief. A neutral surrounding lets you and what you are doing stand out.

Ask yourself

"When did I last feel truly calm?"

Relief

A feeling that you can **put down demands** along with work clothes.

And why?

After a day among people it can be pleasant to change into simple soft clothes. The benefit lies in the whole transition, you put down clothes, demands and the need to make some impression. Grey can accompany this moment if you link it with comfort.

And what if I asked you now?

"What can I put down today?"

Distance

A wish to keep **a little aside** and look from above.

And why?

Grey does not raise its voice. It can give you room to observe and not to decide at once. Just watch whether it is a distance that helps you, or a wall that separates you from people.

And try answering now

"What do I need to withdraw from for a while now?"

Boredom

A feeling that **everything repeats anyway** and nothing moves.

And why?

Grey phrases, like grey drabness, add to the colour a meaning that belongs to the life around it. A surrounding without change and without light naturally becomes tiresome. Grey need not be to blame.

And now one question for you

"What would bring me a small change today?"

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Feelings and experience

Deeper and slower states that settle in us. You often recognise them only after a while.

Privacy

A feeling that **you do not have to be in view** and need not explain anything.

And why?

When you have had enough stimuli, you long for a surrounding that announces nothing more. A grey jumper or room can be clear. At other times the chance to disappear a little may attract you. Both are fine.

Ask yourself

"Where do I allow myself to be unobserved, and am I well there?"

Simplicity

Joy in **fewer things** competing for attention.

And why?

By experience, a smaller number of things can free the head. Grey here serves as a neutral ground. But take care that simplicity does not become the removal of what you love.

And what if I asked you now?

"Does simplicity help me, or did I remove even what I love?"

Dulling

A feeling that everything **has gone quiet and grey**.

And why?

In research on colour associations grey is linked with sadness. A link in the imagination, though, is not proof that a grey room saddens everyone. If the dulling lasts long, or takes away your joy in ordinary things, talk to someone close or to a professional.

And try answering now

"Is it a grey day, or has something in me not moved for a long time?"

Loneliness

A feeling that **it is cold around you** and nobody is looking.

And why?

A grey city, a grey corridor and a grey wall can evoke a sense of absence of others. It helps to notice whether it is the colour, or also noise, emptiness and missing people. Sometimes you need quiet. At other times a person with whom you need not be alone in that quiet.

And now one question for you

"Who could I be at peace with today?"

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My grey is not the same as your grey

The colour itself **experiences nothing**. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the **experience** sticks to it. The colour then becomes a **shortcut**. That is why **your own reaction** is the most important.

- **Grey coat**
  For one elegance, for another hiding.
- **Grey room**
  For one clarity, for another a catalogue where she does not want to live.
- **Grey city**
  For one calm and architecture, for another concrete and loneliness.
- **Grey hair**
  For one relief from dyeing, for another a change she does not want yet.
- **Grey stone**
  For one a touch that stops, for another a thing on the way.

Why does it attract me right now?

Perhaps you have had enough stimuli. All day somebody wants something and at home you long for surroundings that announce nothing more. A grey jumper can be comfortable. **It need not be a secret message about your soul.**

When I see grey on someone else

You meet a woman who always walks around in grey. What occurs to you? Is she inconspicuous, elegant, tired? The first impression comes quickly, but the story you add to it need not belong to that woman. Try splitting your impression into three things. What I see, say a grey coat and a simple cut. How it affects me, say calmly or sternly. And what I infer, say that she is reserved. **The first point describes the clothing, the second your experience, the third already ascribes traits to a person.**

When to keep it and when to take some away

Keep it when you feel good beside it and do not have to talk yourself into a pleasant impression. Take away when the whole seems cold, blurring or foreign. First try one change. Add a flower, a picture, a coloured fabric or ceramics. Then notice whether the change pleases you even after the first enthusiasm. **Sometimes it is not colour you lack, but rest or company.**

Ask yourself

“Which sentence about grey is loudest in me? Whose is it, actually?”

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